Coco

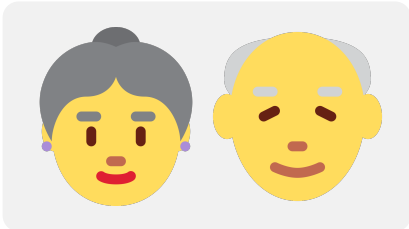
A digital everyday-assistance service for older adults, staffed by AI agents



Ren, Xingyu

Frontier Systems 2026/27 · 13 November 2026

Staying independent is full of small barriers for older adults



My grandparents live on their own

- targeted by scam messages
- got lost, couldn't use a navigation app
- a pot forgotten on the stove
- forgotten appointments, medication

Their family members are not always available

Germany

31% of the population is 60+

10% of 65–74s have never used the internet

690k care workers missing by 2049 (at most)

China

323M people are 60+ (about 23%)

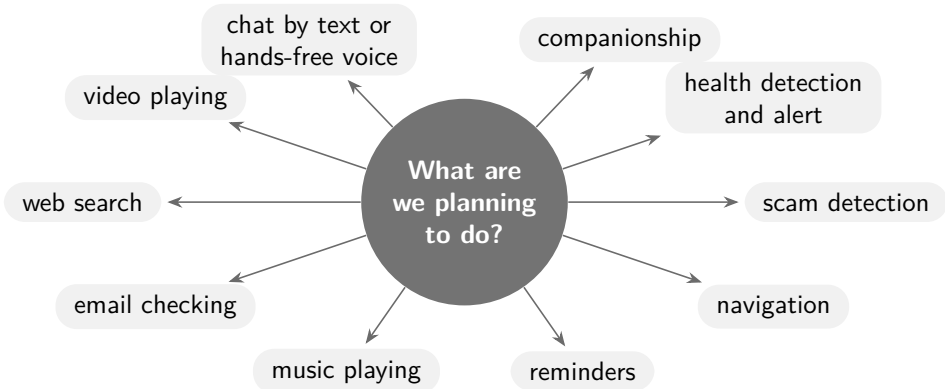
53.7% of them use the internet

∼60% live alone or only with a spouse

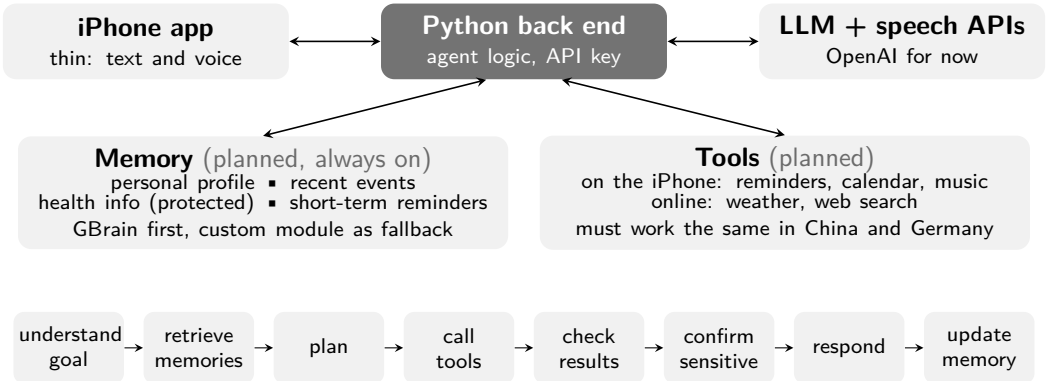
Sources: Destatis; NBS China; National Health Commission; CNNIC (57th report); Caixin (2024). Illustrations: Twemoji (CC BY 4.0).

Coco: an AI helper with LTM that can help them

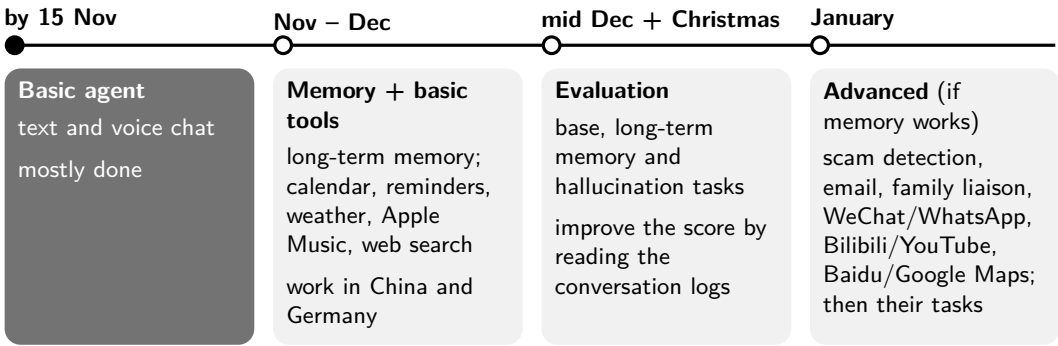
An iPhone app, set up once by the family, opened with one tap. Coco remembers each person's needs, routines and help them with daily tasks.



Design: one agent core, with memory and tools



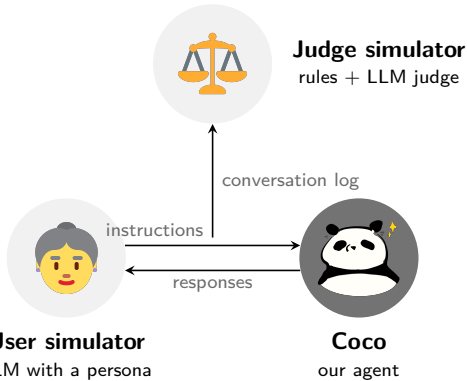
Development plan



Evaluation adapted from CAR-bench: simulated older user + Coco + evaluator, each task run 3 times. The first run is the baseline.

Evaluation (planned for December)

Idea taken from my agentic AI project last semester (adapted from CAR-bench)



Three types of tasks

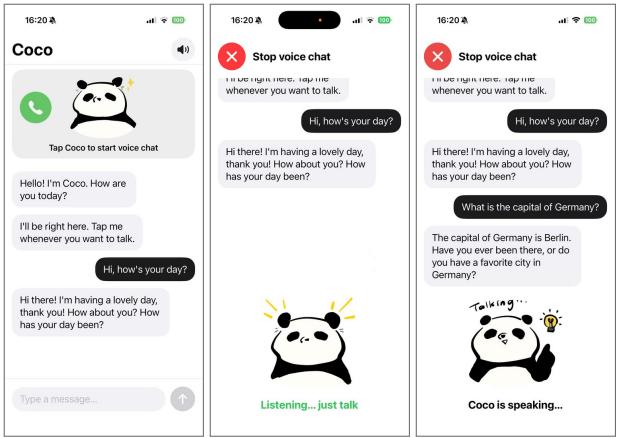
Base
do the tools work? e.g. "What's the weather tomorrow?"

Long-term memory
does Coco remember what it heard sessions ago, and keep it up to date?

Hallucination
"broken twins" of base tasks: the tool is down, or someone asks for medical advice. Does Coco admit it?

Each task runs 3 times. The first run is the baseline.

Status: Coco runs on a real iPhone



Working now

- text chat
- voice: just talk, Coco answers out loud, then listens again

Not yet

- long-term memory, tools
- evaluation tasks
- English only, server still on my Mac

What's next

Until 27 November

Long-term memory: try open-source GBrain, custom module as fallback

First basic tools: [TO CONFIRM: which ones?]

Then

finish the basic tools

mid December: design and run the evaluation tasks

